

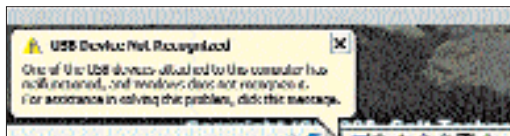
Q&A

Your Questions, Our Answers

Stretching It Too Far

Q I have a Creative Webcam. The cable wasn't long enough, so I bought a 5-metre USB-to-USB extension cable. Now, when I connect the Webcam using the cable, a message appears: "USB Device Not Recognized". When I connect the Webcam directly, it works fine.

Bhupinder Singh



An unfortunate USB device not recognised

A Because of latency issues, a USB cable can only be 5 metres long. If you need to extend the length of the cable, you need a USB repeaters or USB relays to reduce signal loss.

Go Away!

Q I have Windows XP, and I installed Windows 98 from the DOS prompt. It started appearing as the first item in the OS choice menu. Later, I deleted all the Windows 98 files because I didn't want it any more, but it still appears in the boot menu. How can I get rid of it?

Via e-mail

A The items that appear in the OS choice menu at boot time are stored in a file—Boot.ini. You can edit this file to remove the Windows 98 menu item. Open *Control Panel > System*. Click on *Advanced*, and under "Startup and Recovery", click *Settings*. In the window that opens, you can change the default OS by choosing Windows XP from the drop-down box. If you want to stop the item from appearing, you need to click *Edit*. The Boot.ini file will open in Notepad. Scroll down to the [boot loader] section, which will look like this:

```
[boot loader]
timeout=30
default=multi(0)disk(0)rdisk(0)partition(2)\WI
NDOWS
[operating systems]
multi(0)disk(0)rdisk(0)partition(2)\WINDOWS=
"Windows 98" /noexecute=optin /fastdetect
multi(0)disk(0)rdisk(0)partition(1)\WINDOWS=
"Microsoft Windows XP Professional" /noexe-
cute=optin /fastdetect
```

Under the [boot loader] section, change the line "default=multi(0)disk(0)rdisk(0)partition(2)\WI NDOWS" to "default=multi(0)disk(0)rdisk(0)partition(1)\WI NDOWS".

Delete the line "multi(0)disk(0)rdisk(0)partition(2)\WINDOWS= "Windows 98" /noexecute=optin /fastdetect"

Save the file and you're done. The next time you boot your computer, you will only see the "Microsoft Windows XP Professional" option.

We're Sorry To Inform You That...

Q I have a P4 2.8 GHz (Northwood, Socket 478) on an Intel D865PERL board. My processor's fan failed. While pulling out the heat sink / fan, the thermal compound (Intel-shipped) between the heat sink and the processor was so adhesive that the CPU's thermal spreader got plucked out, flushing the liquid compound all over the CPU area of the board. *(The thermal spreader is a metallic plate over the CPU's core that's hollow, filled with liquid thermal compound.)*

I understand that if I just replace the plate, it would create an air gap between the core and the plate. If I use the CPU in that condition, it would toast the core. What do I do? Luckily, my board survived the spill.

Tarun Raju

A While you might have been lucky that the motherboard survived the spill, we have to say that the same is not the case with your processor. Because the CPU's thermal spreader is considered a part of the processor, its getting dislodged from the processor body means that the processor has been damaged—and this damage is not repairable. Since this is physical damage, you cannot avail of the warranty even if the processor is under one.

Done In A Jiffy!

Q Whenever I schedule a disk check on Windows XP, the following error comes up at the next reboot:

"Disk checkup

Checking file system on C:

The type of the file system is NTFS

Cannot open volume for Direct Access

Windows has finished checking the disk"

All other partitions are checked normally except the C: partition. I log into Windows as Administrator.

Sandeep Jain

A The problem can be resolved by installing the latest Service Pack and hotfixes for Windows XP. According to Microsoft, this problem has been resolved in Service Pack 2.

Call A Rose By Any Other Name...

Q I want to know what difference setting a hard disk or an optical drive as Master or Slave would make. How can I make a drive Primary or Slave? What are the advantages and disadvantages of both?

Manish Sihotra